

The GIFT International Financial Services Centre (GIFT IFSC) is a financial centre and special economic zone in GIFT City, India. It was established in 2015 as a financial hub to provide world-class infrastructure and services for financial institutions and companies operating in areas such as banking, insurance, capital markets, and asset management. GIFT IFSC is regulated by the International Financial Services Centres Authority, an independent regulator exclusive to the zone.

History

GIFT International Finance Services Centre (GIFT IFSC) is a special economic zone (SEZ) located in the Indian state of Gujarat, which was set up to promote international financial services.

It was established in the year 2007 by the Government of Gujarat. The GIFT project was first proposed in the year 2007, when the then Chief Minister of Gujarat, Narendra Modi, announced the establishment of an international financial services centre in Gujarat. The project was initiated with the aim of creating a world-class financial hub that could compete with the likes of London, New York, and Hong Kong.

The foundation stone for the GIFT project was laid on 28 January 2011, by the then Finance Minister of India, Pranab Mukherjee, and the then Chief Minister of Gujarat, Narendra Modi. The project was launched with an initial investment of ₹78 billion (equivalent to ₹160 billion or US\$1.7 billion in 2023).

The first phase of the GIFT project was completed in the year 2017, with the construction of 10 buildings, including two iconic towers – GIFT One and GIFT Two. GIFT One is a 28-storey tower, while GIFT Two is a 29-storey tower. These towers are the tallest buildings in Gujarat, with a height of 122 meters.

The GIFT project has been developed as a special economic zone (SEZ) under the SEZ Act, 2005. It is spread over an area of 359 hectares (886 acres) and has been designed as a self-contained city with state-of-the-art infrastructure, including a dedicated power plant,

water treatment plant, and an underground utility tunnel.

Chronology

GIFT IFSC Structure

Key executives and members of the board of directors at the GIFT IFSC:

CEO: Ajay Pandey is the Managing Director & Group CEO of GIFT City. He is responsible for overseeing the development and management of the GIFT IFSC. Prior to joining GIFT City, Pandey served in various leadership roles in the financial services industry, including as the CEO of IDFC Financial Holding Company Ltd.

President: Tapan Ray is the executive director at GIFT City and also serves as the President of GIFT IFSC. Ray has extensive experience in the banking and financial services sector, having previously served as the Secretary for the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and as a Director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India.

Governor: Roopa Deepak Rawat is the current Governor of GIFT IFSC. Rawat has a background in law and has previously worked as an advocate in various Indian courts, as well as serving as a legal advisor to several state governments.

Chairman: Sudhir Mankad is the Chairman of GIFT City. Mankad has had a long and distinguished career in the Indian civil service, having served as the Chief Secretary of the Government of Gujarat and as the Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister of India.

Board of Directors: The Board of Directors of GIFT IFSC includes eminent industry leaders and government officials. Some of the current members of the Board of Directors are:

Ajay Kumar Tomer: Joint Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance

Amitabh Chaudhry: CEO, Axis Bank

Punit Shah: Executive Director, GIFT IFSC

Jaijit Bhattacharya: President, Centre for Digital Economy Policy Research

Jayen Shah: Partner, Ernst & Young LLP

Rajeshwar Burla: Managing Director & Head of Financial Institutions Group, Asia Pacific,
Standard Chartered

Uday Kotak: Managing Director & CEO, Kotak Mahindra Bank

See also

Dubai International Financial Centre

International Financial Services District

International Financial Services Centre, Dublin

Astana International Financial Centre

International Financial Services Centres Authority

References

External links

Official website